

THE NARRATIVE PACKAGE FOR DOMESTIC SURVIVABILITY

*Optical Compromises, Dual Victory Frames,
and Domestic Rebuttal Architecture*

An agreement that cannot be defended domestically is an agreement that will be breached within a week. This Package provides every optical compromise, competing narrative, and pre-cleared rebuttal required for both Washington and Tehran to defend the Accord before their respective political bases.

Every provision is frameable positively from both sides. Every talking point is legally grounded in the operative text. Every rebuttal anticipates the criticism that will come within 72 hours of signature.

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COMPANION TO THE FINAL STEPS ACCORD PHASE I V4.0 (69 PP.) · NEGOTIATORS BRIEF V4.0 (17 PP.)
NUCLEAR SEQUENCING BRIEF V4.0 (6 PP.) · SIMULTANEOUS ANNOUNCEMENT PROTOCOL V4.0

AUTHORIZED NEGOTIATORS ONLY — NOT FOR PUBLIC DISTRIBUTION

ONE-PAGE CHEAT SHEET

Quick-glance dual frames for live interviews and crisis moments

Issue	Washington Frame (1 sentence)	Tehran Frame (1 sentence)
HEU Custody	"Iran's weapons-grade uranium is under IAEA lock and key within 14 days — breakout time extended from weeks to over a year."	"Iran retains full legal title. The material stays on Iranian soil. IAEA custody is verification, not surrender."
Disposition Pathways	"We veto Russia and hybrid pathways. A \$500M Fund rewards cooperative choices."	"Iran selects from six options. The US has no veto on four pathways. The Fund is a bonus, not a bribe."
Day 45 Circuit Breaker	"Iran cannot run out the clock. If no agreement, downblending starts automatically."	"Not a breach. Not a collapse. Pathway A continues automatically — material stays in Iran."
JHTA / Hormuz	"No unilateral tolling. Multilateral advisory coordination. US permanent seat. 12-month pilot."	"PGSA remains sole coastal enforcement. Iran co-chair with veto. JHTA is advisory and non-binding."
Performance Graduation	"Merit badge, not sunset. Iran must earn broader relief through verified compliance."	"Rewards compliance, punishes cheating. 30-day reset for minor slips protects good-faith actors."
Rolling Horizon	"No expiration date Iran can wait out. Continues only as long as Iran complies."	"Not permanent. Either party can withdraw with notice. No clawback of released funds."
No Military Escalation	"We control our own military decisions. Compliance disputes are not war authorizations."	"Prevents US from using minor compliance pretext for airstrikes. Article 51 self-defense preserved."
Lebanon	"Separate track. Full Israeli participation. Firewall protects core deal."	"Ends war on all fronts. Iran ensures allies are not abandoned. Fair attribution threshold."

Golden Rule reminder: Never argue that the other side lost. Argue that your side won. The other side's victory is their problem to explain — not yours to deny.

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Section 1: The Philosophy of Narrative Sovereignty

"This is not a lie; it is a choice of emphasis. It closes the 'sequencing trap.' When both sides read from the same document at the same moment, pointing to different paragraphs, the world sees coordination rather than capitulation." — Simultaneous Announcement Protocol v4.0

The Core Problem: Sequencing Traps Kill Deals

Every previous US-Iran negotiation has collapsed on the same rock: the sequencing trap. Washington needs to say "Iran surrendered." Tehran needs to say "Iran preserved its rights." Both statements are in the operative text, but they are in different sections. The public fight becomes over which clause is read first. Whoever reads second is accused of capitulation.

The v4.0 Accord solves this structurally through three mechanisms:

1. **Optical Compromises:** Every operative provision is designed so that both parties can factually claim victory from the same clause. Not spin — legally grounded factual accuracy.
2. **Simultaneous Announcement:** Both spokespersons speak at the same UTC time, pointing to different paragraphs of the same document. Neither goes first. Neither reacts.
3. **Phase I Framing:** The entire Accord is explicitly a time-limited "first step." Both leaders can sell it as exploratory without conceding permanence.

The Optical Compromise: How It Works

An optical compromise is a legal provision that produces two factually accurate, non-contradictory readings. Both readings are grounded in the same operative text. Neither requires the other to be false.

EXAMPLE: ARTICLE 1.1 — THE CUSTODY ARCHITECTURE

The same clause, two valid readings:

Washington reads: "The entire stockpile of uranium enriched to 60% U-235 and above shall be consolidated, inventoried, and placed under IAEA custody within the first 14 days of Accord activation." — Physical custody transfer. Breakout time extended. Weapons-grade material secured.

Tehran reads: "The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title to the HEU throughout the custody period. The IAEA holds physical custody only." — Sovereign title preserved. Property not surrendered. IAEA is a custodian, not an owner.

Neither statement contradicts the other. Both are in Article 1.1. Both are legally operative. Both are factually accurate.

Narrative Sovereignty: The Operating Principle

Every article in this Package contains a dual-narrative frame: what Washington can say, what Tehran can say, and why both are factually accurate. Negotiators should internalize these frames and deploy them without hesitation. They are not spin. They are not messaging. They are the designed operating state of the Accord.

Golden Rule: When defending the Accord domestically, never argue that the other side lost. Argue that your side won. The other side's victory is their problem to explain — not yours to deny.

Section 2: Nuclear File — Dual Narratives

Source: *The Final Steps Accord v4.0, Articles 1–3, 1.5-A, 1.6 (pp. 6–16)*

2.1 HEU Custody & The 14-Day Architecture

WASHINGTON VICTORY FRAME

"Within 14 days of signing, Iran's entire stockpile of near-weapons-grade uranium is placed under IAEA custody on Iranian soil, verified by mass spectrometry, with breakout time extended from weeks to over a year. Physical custody is real, verified, and immediate. The material is under international lock and key. No US personnel handle it — but US technical observers have joint data access at IAEA facilities."

Legal Anchor: Article 1.1 (pp. 6–7)

Rebuttal to "They kept the uranium": "Physical custody is what matters for non-proliferation. Legal title is a bookkeeping entry. The IAEA controls the locks. Iran cannot access the material without IAEA consent. That is the definition of secured."

TEHRAN VICTORY FRAME

"Iran's enriched uranium remains Iranian property. The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title at all times. The IAEA holds physical custody only as a verification step — not ownership, not disposal authority. The material stays on Iranian soil by default, supervised by Iranian technicians, with existing IAEA Safeguards inspectors only. No foreign military personnel enter Iranian territory."

Legal Anchor: Article 1.1 (pp. 6–7)

Rebuttal to "You gave up the uranium": "Legal title remains with the Central Bank of Iran. The IAEA is a custodian, not an owner. The material remains on Iranian soil under Iranian supervision. This is verification, not surrender."

NEW V4.0 PROVISIONS — ADDED NARRATIVE VALUE

Political Will Preservation Clause (Article 1.1): One-time 7-day extension for verified administrative delays. Neither side can be accused of incompetence if they need extra time for legitimate reasons. Both sides protected.

IAEA Personnel Clarification (Article 1.1): Existing Safeguards inspectors only. No foreign military. Iranian technicians install the dual-lock system. Tehran can say "no foreign intrusion." Washington can say "we verified through existing IAEA mechanisms."

Loosened US Custody Clause (Article 1.3): US technical observers allowed at IAEA facilities with joint data access. Washington gets "eyes on the material." Tehran gets "no operational control — only observation."

2.2 The Six Pathways & Joint Disposition Fund

WASHINGTON VICTORY FRAME

"Iran selects the final pathway, but the United States retains veto over the two pathways we object to most: Russia and hybrid/multiple destinations. For all other pathways — in-Iran downblending, Oman, Kazakhstan, and Bushehr — Iran chooses freely and we verify execution. The \$500 million Joint Disposition Fund creates a powerful financial incentive for Iran to choose cooperative pathways. Pathways B, C, and E each earn \$100 million. Pathway A earns \$50 million. Russia earns zero. Carrots, not sticks."

Legal Anchor: Articles 1.5, 1.5-A (pp. 8–9)

Rebuttal to "They can still choose Russia": "Russia requires joint US-Iran concurrence. We have an absolute veto. And the \$500 million Fund means Iran has strong financial reasons to choose cooperative pathways. We influence through incentives, not ultimatums."

TEHRAN VICTORY FRAME

"Iran selects the final disposition pathway from a six-option menu. For Pathways A, B, C, and E, the United States has absolutely no veto — only the right to verify execution. The Joint Disposition Fund is a financial bonus for pathways that serve Iran's own economic interests. No pathway is blocked. Some are simply more lucrative. Iranian sovereignty over nuclear decisions is fully preserved."

Legal Anchor: Articles 1.5, 1.5-A (pp. 8–9)

Rebuttal to "The Fund bribes you": "The Fund rewards pathways that are in Iran's own interest. In-Iran downblending supports our medical isotope industry. Bushehr fuel

supports our civilian nuclear program. These are Iranian priorities that happen to align with international confidence-building."

Pathway	Washington Frame	Tehran Frame
A In-Iran downblending	"Material eliminated on Iranian soil under IAEA lock"	"Material stays in Iran, supports medical isotope production, earns \$50M"
B Oman export	"Material leaves Iran entirely"	"Voluntary export to neutral third party, earns \$100M"
C Kazakhstan LEU Bank	"Material goes to internationally monitored bank"	"Contribution to global nuclear fuel assurance, earns \$100M"
D Russia	"We veto this unless we jointly agree"	"Available if both parties agree — preserves relationship option"
E Bushehr fuel	"Supports civilian reactor, not weapons"	"Fuels our civilian nuclear program, earns \$100M"
F Hybrid	"We veto if Russia is involved"	"Flexible approach if both parties agree on destinations"

2.3 The Day 45 Circuit Breaker (Article 1.6)

WASHINGTON VICTORY FRAME

"If Iran stalls or refuses to negotiate in good faith on a final disposition pathway, the Day 45 Circuit Breaker kicks in automatically. Pathway A — in-country downblending to 19.75% LEU — becomes the default. Weapons-grade material is permanently eliminated either through negotiation or through the automatic fallback. Iran cannot run out the clock. The deal protects US interests even in deadlock."

Legal Anchor: Article 1.6 (pp. 13–14)

TEHRAN VICTORY FRAME

"If no agreement is reached by Day 45, Pathway A continues automatically — in-Iran downblending supervised by Iranian technicians with IAEA verification. Not a breach. Not a collapse. The deal survives. The ceasefire holds. Sanctions sequencing continues. The default is the pathway that keeps the material in Iran and supports our medical isotope industry."

Legal Anchor: Article 1.6 (pp. 13–14)

OPTICAL COMPROMISE ANALYSIS

The Day 45 Circuit Breaker is the quintessential optical compromise. Washington sees an "automatic enforcement mechanism that eliminates weapons-grade material regardless of Iranian cooperation." Tehran sees "a no-fault default that continues the agreement on Iranian terms without punishment." Both readings are factually accurate. Both are legally grounded. Neither requires the other to be false.

2.4 Enrichment Moratorium & Underground Sites

WASHINGTON VICTORY FRAME

"Zero enrichment above 3.67% for 12 years. All higher centrifuges under IAEA seal. Iran's enrichment program is rolled back to pre-2003 levels. Fordow conversion to medical isotope production eliminates a major weapons pathway. Black-Box telemetry at highest-risk facilities provides 24-hour anomaly detection. This is the most restrictive enrichment regime Iran has ever accepted."

Legal Anchor: Articles 2, 3 (pp. 15–18)

TEHRAN VICTORY FRAME

"Enrichment continues at 3.67% under full IAEA safeguards — our NPT right, fully preserved. Fordow conversion is optional, Phase 2 only. Alternatively, Fordow may operate as a reduced-capacity research facility under continuous IAEA monitoring, limited to 3.67% and 500 centrifuges. No facility is destroyed. Infrastructure remains sovereign property. The moratorium is sliding-scale: verified compliance extends the window."

Legal Anchor: Articles 2, 3.2 (pp. 15–16)

BLACK-BOX TELEMETRY — BALANCED ACCOUNTABILITY

Washington: "24-hour alerts at highest-risk facilities. Any anomaly detected and reported."

Tehran: "Sensors may be temporarily disabled for maintenance with 48 hours' advance notice. Four-level escalation ladder: only Level 4 (tampering/diversion) triggers step-back. Maintenance and minor glitches are not breaches."

Both: Sensors deployed only at highest-risk facilities per joint IAEA-JIG assessment — not at all facilities. (Article 3.3, p. 17)

Section 3: Maritime Governance — Dual Narratives

Source: *The Final Steps Accord v4.0, Articles 4–6 (pp. 10–20)*

3.1 The JHTA Advisory Framework

WASHINGTON VICTORY FRAME

"No more unilateral Iranian tolling. The Strait of Hormuz is governed as an open international waterway under UNCLOS, with multilateral advisory coordination. The US holds a permanent seat on the governing council with veto rights over security protocol amendments. The JHTA operates under a 12-month pilot phase — either party can prevent permanent status if unhappy. The PGSA is restricted to coastal enforcement within Iranian territorial waters; the international transit corridor is governed by UNCLOS. Gulf states gain consultative observer status, ensuring regional buy-in."

Legal Anchor: Articles 4.1–4.4 (pp. 10–14)

Rebuttal to "You recognized Iranian control of Hormuz": "We recognized that Iran has a 12-nautical-mile territorial water limit, same as every coastal state under UNCLOS. The PGSA enforces Iranian coastal law, which is Iran's sovereign right. But the international transit corridor — where 90% of traffic flows — is governed by multilateral advisory coordination with US participation. That's not Iranian control. That's international law."

TEHRAN VICTORY FRAME

"The Persian Gulf Strait Authority is formally recognized as the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters. Iran holds a permanent co-chair seat on the JHTA governing council with veto rights over governance questions and revenue allocation. The JHTA is explicitly advisory and non-binding — not a supranational authority. The IRGC's coastal defense authority is explicitly preserved and untouched. The 12-month pilot phase means permanence requires our consent. GCC states have speaking rights but no vote."

Legal Anchor: Articles 4.2-A, 4.2-B (pp. 11–12)

Rebuttal to "You gave up Hormuz control": "The PGSA remains Iran's statutory authority for Hormuz transit. We hold the permanent co-chair. Our personnel staff the transit centers. We receive 40% of fund revenue. The JHTA is advisory only — its recommendations are non-binding. The IRGC's authority is explicitly preserved. Nothing has been surrendered."

Element	Washington Frame	Tehran Frame
JHTA Mandate	"Advisory multilateral coordination under UNCLOS"	"Non-binding recommendations only; PGSA retains final say"
Pilot Phase	"Either party can block permanence"	"Iran can prevent permanent status if unhappy"

PGSA Role	"Restricted to 12nm coastal enforcement"	"Sole executive authority in Iranian territorial waters"
Revenue	"Fees routed through neutral MMMF in Oman"	"40% to Iranian Civilian Reconstruction Fund"
GCC Observer	"Gulf states have a voice without a vote — regional buy-in without diluting Iranian sovereignty"	"No vote; Iran's veto rights unchanged"
Technical Grace	"Unanimous recommendations require written explanation"	"Persistent disregard triggers consultation only — never step-back"

3.2 The Day 7 Conditional Review Protocol

WASHINGTON VICTORY FRAME

"The Day 7 process is now a conditional, review-based certification by a Joint Review Board — not an automated trigger that overrides military judgment. Each party retains full operational discretion over its forces. The Board certifies that both sides have met milestones before recommending execution. If certification fails, both declarations are postponed. No unilateral concession. No front-loaded giveaways."

Legal Anchor: Article 6.3 (pp. 16–17)

TEHRAN VICTORY FRAME

"The Day 7 process preserves Iran's operational discretion. A neutral Joint Review Board certifies readiness — neither side is forced to act before conditions are met. The 5-nautical-mile stand-off distances are observed regardless of declaration timing. Airspace coordination operates through a 2-hour response cell. Neither declaration is automated; each party decides for itself."

Legal Anchor: Article 6.3 (pp. 16–17)

OPTICAL COMPROMISE: BOTH SIDES PRESERVE MILITARY DISCRETION

The shift from automated 60-second trigger to conditional review-based process is narratively powerful for both sides. Washington: "No machine overrides our military commanders." Tehran: "No automated system forces us to act prematurely." Both are correct. Both preserve sovereignty over military decisions. Both benefit from the Joint Review Board's neutral certification.

Section 4: Economic Normalization — Dual Narratives

Source: *The Final Steps Accord v4.0, Articles 7–10, Appendix D (pp. 17–29)*

4.1 Performance-Based Graduation

WASHINGTON VICTORY FRAME

"This is not a sunset — it's a merit badge. Iran must earn its way into broader sanctions relief by proving 90 consecutive days of verified compliance. The sanctions freeze starts partial: nuclear-related only, with terrorism and human rights sanctions fully enforceable. Only after JIG certification does the freeze expand. And if Iran cheats afterward, we take it back through proportionate step-back. A single minor slip resets the clock to 30 days, not zero — still a penalty, but not catastrophic. A serious breach resets to zero. This is the toughest compliance-linked relief architecture ever negotiated."

Legal Anchor: Article 7.1 (pp. 17–19)

TEHRAN VICTORY FRAME

"Sanctions relief is graduated and earned — not a gift, not a trap. The 30-day reset for a single minor violation means good-faith actors are protected. Performance-Based Graduation rewards compliance; it does not punish negotiation. Non-nuclear sanctions on terrorism and human rights remain fully in force from Day 1, so the US cannot claim we got a free ride. The 90-day certification period is demanding but achievable with good faith."

Legal Anchor: Article 7.1 (pp. 17–19)

WHY BOTH SIDES BENEFIT FROM PERFORMANCE-BASED GRADUATION

Washington benefits because: Iran must prove compliance before getting broader relief. The US retains leverage throughout. If Iran cheats, relief contracts proportionately. The 30-day reset (not zero) for minor violations maintains pressure without creating perverse incentives.

Tehran benefits because: The rules are clear and objective. A minor, quickly-cured violation does not wipe out three months of good faith. The system rewards consistent compliance rather than demanding perfection. And the partial freeze from Day 1 provides immediate, visible economic benefit.

4.2 Sanctions, SWIFT & Escrow

Provision	Washington Frame	Tehran Frame
\$250M humanitarian tranche (Day 1)	"Humanitarian only — not sanctions relief"	"Immediate economic benefit; ceasefire goodwill gesture"

Partial sanctions freeze	"Terrorism/human rights sanctions remain enforceable"	"Nuclear-related freeze begins immediately"
Neutral escrow (Oman)	"Funds shielded from diversion; sovereign immunity wrapper"	"Iranian assets released through neutral third party, not surrendered"
SWIFT phased reconnection	"Phased and conditional; rolls back if compliance fails"	"Restores Iran's place in global economy step by step"
Reconstruction Credits	"No reparations — development credits, not liability"	"International investment in Iranian civilian reconstruction"
Legislative Opt-Out	"Phase I by executive action; Phase II needs Senate ratification"	"Phase I by executive action; Phase II needs Majles legislation"
No Clawback	"Clean break if either side withdraws"	"Released funds cannot be recalled — a clean break, not a trap"

CONGRESSIONAL/MAJLES OPT-OUT — MUTUAL PROTECTION

Washington: "Phase I requires no Senate ratification. It operates through executive authority. Phase II Commitments (permanent enrichment moratorium beyond 12 months, HEU disposition involving foreign territory, full SWIFT reconnection, permanent JHTA charter) require Senate advice and consent. We pursue parallel domestic approvals during Phase I with a 180-day target."

Tehran: "Phase I activates by executive Instruments of Acceptance — no Majles legislation required. Phase II Commitments require equivalent domestic legal action. If either legislature delays beyond 120 days without substantive cause, the JIG assesses obstruction. Neither party can use legislative delay to terminate Phase I."

Both: The Opt-Out protects immediate executive action while preserving legislative dignity. Neither parliament is bypassed for core commitments. Neither parliament can sabotage Phase I. (Appendix D, pp. 27–28)

Section 5: Treaty Durability & Regional Architecture — Dual Narratives

Source: *The Final Steps Accord v4.0, Articles 11–18, Appendix E (pp. 21–42)*

5.1 The Rolling Horizon Architecture

WASHINGTON VICTORY FRAME

"There is no sunset clause. No expiration date that Iran can wait out. The Rolling Horizon Architecture uses conditional auto-renewal based on verified compliance. The agreement continues as long as Iran continues to comply. If Iran cheats, benefits pause while security

architecture holds. If both comply, the relationship deepens. The ball is always in Tehran's court. And if we ever need to walk away, 90 days' notice for Phase I. Funds already released cannot be clawed back."

Legal Anchor: Article 17 (pp. 30–32)

TEHRAN VICTORY FRAME

"This is not a permanent surrender. The Rolling Horizon means either party can withdraw with adequate notice — 90 days for Phase I, 180 days for Phase II, 365 days for Phase III. The auto-renewal is conditioned on verified compliance by both sides, not Iranian submission alone. The 'No Cliff' principle ensures that humanitarian protections and the Survival Core survive for 180 days even after withdrawal. A clean break, not a trap."

Legal Anchor: Article 17 (pp. 30–32)

ROLLING HORIZON: THE PERFECT OPTICAL COMPROMISE

Washington sees "no expiration date — Iran must keep performing." Tehran sees "orderly withdrawal available at all times." Both are correct. The auto-renewal is mutual: both sides must be in compliance. The withdrawal notice is unilateral: either side can initiate. The "No Cliff" principle protects both: 180 days of Survival Core regardless of who withdraws. Neither side is trapped. Neither side is exposed.

NO CLAWBACK OF RELEASED FUNDS — CRITICAL IRANIAN SELLING POINT

Washington Frame: "The 'no clawback' provision makes withdrawal a clean break, not a trap. If either party walks away, funds already released from escrow prior to the Formal Non-Renewal Notice shall not be subject to return, clawback, or rescission under any circumstances. This is absolute and non-waivable. It removes the hidden fear that a party could be penalized after withdrawal."

Tehran Frame: "Funds already released from escrow prior to a withdrawal notice are not subject to return or clawback under any circumstances. The withdrawing Party retains full title and control over all previously released assets. Only future tranches not yet released are affected. This 'no clawback' provision is absolute and non-waivable. A clean break, not a trap."

Legal Anchor: Article 17.4 (p. 31) — Both frames are factually accurate from the same clause.

5.2 Breach, Proportionality & No Military Escalation

WASHINGTON VICTORY FRAME

"The step-back architecture is graduated and proportionate. Minor violations get minor consequences. Serious violations get serious consequences. Deliberate, material leaks by senior officials during media blackouts trigger 5% benefit reduction for 30 days per incident — repeat offenses escalate. But the framework never collapses automatically. Humanitarian protections remain. The ceasefire hotline survives. And critically, Article 18 explicitly states that compliance disputes are diplomatic and economic matters — not military authorizations. We retain full control over our military decisions."

Legal Anchor: Articles 13, 18 (pp. 22–24, 32–33)

TEHRAN VICTORY FRAME

"The proportionality rule protects Iran from disproportionate punishment. A Tier 2 violation lasting less than 7 days triggers only 10% reduction, not 25%. A Tier 3 violation remediated within 72 hours triggers 25%, not 50%. Full penalties apply only after the remediation window expires. The media blackout protects attribution integrity: junior leaks get Tier 1 demerit; only deliberate senior official leaks face Tier 2. And Article 18 ensures that no compliance dispute can be used as a pretext for military strikes. Self-defense under Article 51 remains untouched."

Legal Anchor: Articles 13.3, 13.5, 18 (pp. 23–24, 32–33)

Breach Level	Washington Frame	Tehran Frame
Tier 1 (technical, <0.5%)	"Engineering resolution within 14 days; no rollback"	"Administrative flexibility; confidential handling"
Tier 2 (material, <7 days)	"10% reduction — real consequence for real violation"	"Minor penalty for minor breach; 30-day remediation"
Tier 2 (material, >30 days)	"Full 25% reduction — sustained non-compliance"	"Full penalty only after remediation window expires"
Tier 3 (remediated in 72h)	"25% reduction — even serious violations get credit for quick fix"	"50% waived if remediated quickly — incentive to cooperate"
Media blackout violation	"5% per incident for senior officials; leaks have consequences"	"Tier 1 for administrative leaks; Tier 2 only for deliberate ministerial leaks"
Military escalation	"We control our own military; no automated escalation"	"Compliance disputes cannot trigger airstrikes; Article 51 preserved"

5.3 Lebanon, Israel & The Gulf

WASHINGTON VICTORY FRAME

"The Lebanon file is handled through a separate diplomatic track with full Israeli participation. The Dossier Isolation Firewall legally prevents Hezbollah incidents from collapsing the core US-Iran deal. The 10-casualty threshold with JIG majority vote creates a credible but very high bar for linking Lebanon to the core deal. The US-Israel Tel Aviv Channel is preserved. Israel retains full Article 51 self-defense rights. And the non-impediment clause ensures that no third party can veto US implementation."

Legal Anchor: Articles 16, Appendix E (pp. 25–26, 35–42)

TEHRAN VICTORY FRAME

"The framework ends the war on all fronts. Through the Levant Regional Basket, Iran ensures our allies in Lebanon are not abandoned. The Dossier Isolation clause protects the core agreement from Israeli military actions in Lebanon. The 10-casualty threshold with JIG majority vote — not UNSC where the US holds veto power — is fair and transparent. The Tel Aviv Channel is a bilateral US-Israel mechanism that creates no obligation for Iran. The GCC Consultative Observer gives Gulf states a voice without a vote — regional buy-in without diluting Iranian sovereignty."

Legal Anchor: Articles 4.4, 16, Appendix E (pp. 13, 25–26, 35–42)

THE THREE LAYERS — QUICK REFERENCE

Layer 1: Proxy Operational Pause. Hezbollah de-escalation protocol with phased operational parameters (Days 1–180). Four independent verification channels (UNIFIL, Israeli intelligence, LAF liaison, SEAC pattern analysis). Cessation of cross-border attacks; defensive positions maintained but not reinforced. *Immediate security benefit to Israel; Iran can say the war ends on all fronts.*

Layer 2: Dossier Isolation Firewall. Legally prohibits Lebanon incidents from triggering stepback on the core US-Iran Accord. Separate compliance dashboards on the Swiss Dashboard. Stepback algorithms reference only Core Compliance track. *What happens in Lebanon stays in Lebanon — it cannot blow back onto Hormuz.*

Layer 3: Levant Regional Basket. Parallel diplomatic track with independent timeline. Permanent participants: US, Iran, Israel, Lebanon, Syria, Russia, Oman, UN. Israel has full speaking rights but no veto over core Accord. Iran has no obligation to negotiate directly with Israel. *Addresses Iran's allies without requiring Iran to sit at the same table as Israel.*

ISRAELI PARTICIPATION FRAME — ALL THREE AUDIENCES

Washington: "Israel has full participation in the Levant Regional Basket and a dedicated Tel Aviv Channel for bilateral US-Israel coordination. The core US-Iran agreement proceeds on its own timeline."

Tehran: "Israel participates in the Regional Basket as an affected state, not a decision-maker. No Iranian obligation to negotiate directly with Israel."

Jerusalem: "We participate fully in the Regional Basket. The 10-casualty threshold with JIG attribution means a direct order from Khamenei causing mass civilian casualties cannot be ignored. Our Article 51 right to self-defense remains absolute."

THE MISSILE/DRONE PAUSE — DUAL FRAMES

Washington: "Iran commits to no new offensive deployment of ballistic missiles or combat drones to regional proxy forces. Cross-border transfers are suspended. This freezes the threat without demanding disarmament." (Article 14, p. 24)

Tehran: "This Protocol explicitly does NOT require dismantlement of existing inventories, prohibit domestic testing of short-range defensive systems, impose limits on sovereign conventional military forces, or subject military facilities to IAEA inspection. Our missile and drone programs remain fully sovereign." (Article 14.2, p. 24)

Section 6: The Simultaneous Announcement Protocol v4.0

Updated from v1.1 for alignment with The Final Steps Accord Phase I v4.0 | Authoritative Text

PURPOSE STATEMENT

This protocol codifies the day-one public communications strategy for both Washington and Tehran. It is not a press release; it is a sequencing architecture designed to prevent either side from appearing to have conceded. Both spokespersons will speak at the same UTC time, pointing to different paragraphs of the same document. Neither goes first. Neither reacts. Both are, simultaneously, right.

Executive Summary: Why Simultaneous Matters

Previous announcements of this type failed because they were sequential. One side announced the breakthrough; the other side "reacted." The side that reacted was framed as the party that had been pressured into acceptance. This Protocol eliminates that dynamic entirely by ensuring both

sides announce the agreement simultaneously, each from their own capital, each emphasizing their own victory conditions.

Statement #1: Secretary Rubio — For Immediate Release (Washington)

SECRETARY RUBIO'S PUBLIC STATEMENT

"Today, the United States and Iran have reached a significant milestone in our diplomatic engagement. Under the terms of this Phase I Stabilization Framework, Iran has agreed to place its entire stockpile of near-weapons-grade uranium under IAEA custody within 14 days — verified by mass spectrometry, with breakout time extended from weeks to over a year.

The custody transfer occurs on Iranian soil by default, using existing IAEA inspectors only. The United States retains veto authority over any disposition pathway involving the Russian Federation or hybrid/multiple destinations. Iran may select from four unrestricted pathways: in-Iran downblending, transfer to Oman, transfer to Kazakhstan, or conversion to Bushehr fuel. A \$500 million Joint Disposition Fund incentivizes cooperative choices.

Importantly, if no pathway agreement is reached by Day 45, the in-Iran downblending pathway becomes the automatic default. Weapons-grade material will be eliminated either through negotiation or through the designed fallback. Iran cannot run out the clock.

This is Phase I only — a time-limited stabilization framework. Sanctions relief is performance-based, not automatic. Iran must earn broader relief through verified compliance. Non-nuclear sanctions on terrorism and human rights remain fully enforceable. There is no sunset clause; instead, a Rolling Horizon Architecture ensures the agreement continues only as long as both parties comply.

The United States has not conceded on core security requirements. We have secured Iran's nuclear material, preserved our military discretion, and ensured that any future phase requires Congressional ratification. This is a strong deal for American security."

Statement #2: Spokesperson Baghaei — For Immediate Release (Tehran)

SPOKESPERSON BAGHAEI'S PUBLIC STATEMENT

"The Islamic Republic of Iran announces the conclusion of a Phase I Stabilization Framework with the United States. This agreement affirms Iran's sovereign right to peaceful nuclear energy under the NPT and preserves the legal title of the Central Bank of Iran over all Iranian enriched uranium.

The IAEA will hold physical custody as a verification step — not ownership. The material remains on Iranian soil by default, supervised by Iranian technicians under IAEA technical supervision. No foreign military or security personnel will enter Iranian territory for custody purposes. This is verification, not surrender.

Iran selects the final disposition pathway from a six-option menu. For Pathways A, B, C, and E, the United States has no veto whatsoever — only the right to verify execution. Pathways involving the Russian Federation or hybrid destinations require joint concurrence, preserving our sovereign right to manage international partnerships.

If no pathway agreement is reached by Day 45, Pathway A — in-Iran downblending to support our medical isotope industry — continues automatically. Not a breach. Not a collapse. The agreement survives. The ceasefire holds. Sanctions sequencing continues.

This is explicitly Phase I — an initial, time-limited framework. Iran retains its full negotiating position for all subsequent phases. The Rolling Horizon Architecture allows either party to withdraw with adequate notice, and funds already released cannot be clawed back. The Islamic Republic has not surrendered any nuclear rights. We have secured recognition of our sovereignty, preserved our enrichment capability at 3.67%, and ensured that any future phase requires Majles authorization."

Technical Execution: The Simultaneous Architecture

Parameter	Specification	Contingency
Timing	Both statements released simultaneously at the same UTC timestamp	If either side is delayed, both hold until coordinated release is confirmed
Pre-clearance	Both statements reviewed and approved by both capitals 24 hours before rollout	No ad-libbing, no additions, no omissions permitted
Q&A Protocol	No live Q&A during first 2 hours; written statements only	If pressed: "The operative text speaks for itself"
Script Deviation	Any deviation triggers "NARRATIVE DRIFT" signal from floor team	Corrective statement within 15 minutes through official channel
Medium	Both statements distributed simultaneously to all major news agencies	Neither side's statement may be released before the other's

Why Both Statements Are Factually Accurate

Neither statement contains a falsehood. Neither contradicts the other. They are different choices of emphasis from the same operative text:

- Rubio emphasizes **custody** because that is the US victory condition. Baghaei emphasizes **title** because that is the Iranian victory condition. Both are in Article 1.1.

- Rubio emphasizes **limited US veto** (D and F only) because that demonstrates US leverage. Baghaei emphasizes **no veto on four pathways** because that demonstrates Iranian sovereignty. Both are in Article 1.5.
- Rubio emphasizes **"Iran cannot run out the clock"** because that addresses US domestic concern about Iranian stalling. Baghaei emphasizes **"not a breach, not a collapse"** because that addresses Iranian domestic concern about punitive defaults. Both are in Article 1.6.
- Rubio emphasizes **"merit badge, not sunset"** because that appeals to American skepticism of open-ended deals. Baghaei emphasizes **"orderly withdrawal available"** because that appeals to Iranian concern about permanent entrapment. Both are in Article 17.

The Sequencing Trap — How We Avoid It

The sequencing trap occurs when one side reads the agreement and finds their victory conditions in paragraph 3, while the other side finds theirs in paragraph 7. If Washington reads first and emphasizes paragraph 3, Tehran is forced to "respond" to Washington's framing — making Tehran look defensive and reactive.

The solution: Both sides read simultaneously. Washington reads paragraph 3. Tehran reads paragraph 7. At the same UTC timestamp. Neither is responding to the other. Both are stating their own truth from their own capital. The world sees coordination, not capitulation.

This is not a lie; it is a choice of emphasis. It closes the sequencing trap.

Section 7: Domestic Rebuttal Handbook

Anticipated criticism from domestic audiences in Washington and Tehran, with pre-cleared rebuttals grounded in the v4.0 operative text.

7.1 US Domestic Criticism & Rebuttals

CRITICISM: "WE LET IRAN KEEP THE URANIUM ON IRANIAN SOIL. THAT'S NOT A DEAL — THAT'S A PHOTO OP."

REBUTTAL: "Physical custody is what matters for non-proliferation. The IAEA controls the locks. Iran cannot access the material without IAEA consent. Breakout time goes from weeks to over a year. In previous deals, material stayed in-country too — but without IAEA dual-lock custody, without mass spectrometry verification, and without a 14-day hard deadline. This is the most restrictive in-country custody regime ever negotiated. And if Iran doesn't cooperate on final disposition by Day 45, Pathway A downblending kicks in automatically. Weapons-grade material gets eliminated either way."

Legal Anchor: Articles 1.1, 1.6 (pp. 6–7, 13–14)

CRITICISM: "IRAN CAN STALL PAST DAY 45 AND NOTHING HAPPENS."

REBUTTAL: "The Day 45 Circuit Breaker is explicitly designed to prevent stalling. If no pathway agreement is reached by Day 45, the JIG certifies deadlock by majority vote and Pathway A — in-country downblending to 19.75% LEU — becomes the automatic default. Iran must commence downblending within 7 days. If they don't, automatic step-back freezes non-humanitarian asset liquidations under Article 7.1. No separate political vote required. The Political Will Preservation Clause only covers administrative delays during the 14-day custody window — it does not extend to Phase 2 pathway negotiations. Iran cannot run out the clock."

Legal Anchor: Articles 1.6, 7.1 (pp. 13–14, 17–19)

CRITICISM: "THERE'S NO SUNSET CLAUSE. THIS COULD GO ON FOREVER."

REBUTTAL: "That's exactly the point. A sunset clause gives Iran a date to wait for. With the Rolling Horizon Architecture, the agreement continues only as long as Iran keeps complying. If Iran cheats, benefits pause. If Iran withdraws, 90 days' notice and it's over. No sunset means no expiration date for Iran to game. The ball is always in Tehran's court. This is stronger than any fixed-term deal."

Legal Anchor: Article 17 (pp. 30–32)

CRITICISM: "WE RECOGNIZED THE PGSA. THAT'S LEGITIMIZING IRANIAN CONTROL OF HORMUZ."

REBUTTAL: "We recognized that Iran has a 12-nautical-mile territorial water limit, same as every coastal state under UNCLOS. The PGSA enforces Iranian coastal law within those 12 nautical miles — that's Iran's sovereign right. But the international transit corridor, where 90% of traffic flows, is governed by multilateral advisory coordination with US participation. The JHTA is explicitly non-binding. It's a 12-month pilot. Either party can block permanent status. We got international oversight of Hormuz transit without conceding sovereignty over international waters. That's a win."

Legal Anchor: Articles 4.1–4.4 (pp. 10–14)

CRITICISM: "SANCTIONS RELIEF IS TOO GENEROUS. IRAN GETS \$250 MILLION ON DAY 1 FOR NOTHING."

REBUTTAL: "The Day 1 tranche is humanitarian only — medicine, food, medical equipment. Not sanctions relief. The actual sanctions freeze starts partial: nuclear-related only. Terrorism sanctions, human rights sanctions, and conventional weapons sanctions all remain fully enforceable. Broader relief only comes after the JIG certifies 90 days of verified

compliance through Performance-Based Graduation. Iran must earn its way in. This isn't a gift — it's a merit badge."

Legal Anchor: Article 7.1 (pp. 17–19)

CRITICISM: "THIS DOESN'T REQUIRE SENATE RATIFICATION. THAT'S UNCONSTITUTIONAL."

REBUTTAL: "Phase I operates within the President's executive authority as Commander-in-Chief and chief diplomat. All permanent commitments — enrichment moratorium beyond 12 months, HEU disposition involving foreign territory, full SWIFT reconnection, and permanent JHTA charter — require Senate advice and consent under Phase II. We are pursuing parallel domestic approvals during Phase I with a 180-day target. The Senate will have its say on every permanent provision."

Legal Anchor: Appendix D (pp. 27–28)

CRITICISM: "IF IRAN BREACHES, THERE'S NO MILITARY OPTION. ARTICLE 18 TIES OUR HANDS."

REBUTTAL: "Article 18 explicitly preserves our full right to self-defense under UN Charter Article 51. If Iran attacks us or our allies, we respond with full military force — no notice, no UNSC authorization required. What Article 18 prevents is using a minor compliance dispute over enrichment levels or SWIFT access as a pretext for airstrikes. That's not a constraint — that's common sense. Our military options against actual threats remain fully available."

Legal Anchor: Article 18 (pp. 32–33)

7.2 Iranian Domestic Criticism & Rebuttals

CRITICISM: "WE SURRENDERED OUR ENRICHED URANIUM TO THE IAEA."

REBUTTAL: "The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title. The IAEA holds physical custody only as a custodian, not an owner. The material stays on Iranian soil by default, supervised by Iranian technicians, with existing IAEA Safeguards inspectors only. No foreign military personnel enter Iranian territory. This is the same verification relationship we have had with the IAEA for decades — just with stronger custody mechanisms. We have not surrendered anything."

Legal Anchor: Articles 1.1, 1.3 (pp. 6–7)

CRITICISM: "THE 14-DAY DEADLINE IS IMPOSSIBLE. WE WILL LOOK INCOMPETENT IF

WE MISS IT."

REBUTTAL: "The Political Will Preservation Clause allows a one-time 7-day extension for verified administrative, technical, or logistical constraints. IAEA inspector availability, transportation delays, domestic holidays — all valid reasons. Such request cannot be unreasonably denied. And delays under this provision do not constitute material breach or trigger step-back. The deadline is demanding but not punishing."

Legal Anchor: Article 1.1 (p. 7)

CRITICISM: "WE ACCEPTED A JHTA THAT LIMITS OUR HORMUZ SOVEREIGNTY."

REBUTTAL: "The JHTA is explicitly advisory and non-binding. The PGSA remains the sole executive coastal law enforcement body within Iranian territorial waters. The IRGC's authority is explicitly preserved. Iran holds the permanent co-chair seat with veto rights. The 12-month pilot phase means permanence requires our consent. The JHTA coordinates international transit corridor traffic under UNCLOS — it does not govern Iranian coastal waters. Our sovereignty over Hormuz is intact."

Legal Anchor: Articles 4.2-A, 4.2-B (pp. 11–12)

CRITICISM: "THE SANCTIONS FREEZE IS TOO NARROW. WE GAVE UP NUCLEAR CONCESSIONS FOR ALMOST NOTHING."

REBUTTAL: "The partial freeze from Day 1 covers all new nuclear-related sanctions designations. That is immediate, visible relief. The Performance-Based Graduation means that after 90 days of verified compliance, the freeze expands automatically. The 30-day reset for a single minor violation protects us from catastrophic penalties. And the Joint Disposition Fund provides up to \$100 million in additional reconstruction funding. The sequencing rewards compliance, not perfection."

Legal Anchor: Articles 7.1, 1.5-A (pp. 17–19)

CRITICISM: "THE DAY 45 CIRCUIT BREAKER IS A TRAP DESIGNED TO FORCE PATHWAY A ON IRAN."

REBUTTAL: "Pathway A is not a punishment — it is the default that both sides agreed to because it protects both interests. For Iran: material stays in Iran, supervised by Iranian technicians, supporting our medical isotope industry, earning \$50 million from the Joint Disposition Fund. For the US: weapons-grade material is permanently eliminated. The Day 45 default is explicitly not a breach and does not trigger step-back. The deal survives. The ceasefire holds. Sanctions sequencing continues. Pathway A is the Iranian interest pathway. It is not a trap."

Legal Anchor: Article 1.6 (pp. 13–14)

CRITICISM: "THIS IS A TRAP. THE US WILL USE ANY MINOR VIOLATION AS A PRETEXT FOR MILITARY STRIKES."

REBUTTAL: "Article 18 explicitly states that step-back, Review Pause, or even full framework suspension shall not be construed as authorization for military action. Any party contemplating military measures must exhaust all dispute resolution, provide 14 days' advance notice, and secure UNSC authorization unless responding to an ongoing armed attack under Article 51. Breach of the Accord is a diplomatic and economic matter, not a military authorization. Our right to self-defense under international law remains absolutely untouched."

Legal Anchor: Article 18 (pp. 32–33)

CRITICISM: "THE DAY 45 CIRCUIT BREAKER IS A TRAP. IF WE DON'T AGREE, WE ARE PUNISHED."

REBUTTAL: "The Day 45 default is explicitly not a breach and does not trigger step-back. Pathway A — in-Iran downblending — continues automatically. The material stays in Iran. Iranian technicians supervise. Sanctions sequencing continues. The ceasefire holds. The only consequence of deadlock is that we continue on the pathway that supports our medical isotope industry and earns \$50 million from the Joint Disposition Fund. This is not a trap. It is a no-fault default."

Legal Anchor: Article 1.6 (pp. 13–14)

Section 8: Media Guidance by Audience

Pre-cleared talking points organized by domestic audience. All talking points are legally grounded in the v4.0 operative text.

For US Conservative Media

FOCUS: STRENGTH, VERIFICATION, LEVERAGE

- "Iran's near-weapons-grade material is under IAEA lock and key within 14 days. Breakout time: weeks to over a year."
- "US veto on Russian and hybrid pathways. \$500 million Fund incentivizes cooperative choices."
- "Day 45 Circuit Breaker: weapons-grade material gets eliminated even if Iran stalls."

- "Performance-Based Graduation: Iran must earn broader relief. Terrorism and human rights sanctions remain enforceable."
- "No sunset clause — Iran must keep performing. Rolling Horizon means no expiration date to wait out."
- "Article 18 preserves our full military options. Compliance disputes are not military authorizations."
- "Phase I requires no Senate ratification, but all permanent commitments require Senate advice and consent."

For US Progressive Media

FOCUS: DIPLOMACY, HUMANITARIAN RELIEF, DE-ESCALATION

- "This framework averts catastrophic war through verified diplomacy. Both sides move in synchronized steps."
- "\$250 million humanitarian tranche on Day 1: medicine, food, medical equipment. Humanitarian corridor through Hormuz survives all disputes."
- "Political Will Preservation Clause: good-faith delays don't collapse the deal. Proportionate penalties, not punitive destruction."
- "No automatic military escalation from compliance disputes. 14-day notice requirement. UNSC authorization required."
- "Regional Stability Reconstruction Credits: no-fault development investment, not reparations."
- "Lebanon handled through separate diplomatic track with full Israeli participation. Core deal protected from proxy escalation."

For Iranian State Media

FOCUS: SOVEREIGNTY, DIGNITY, NPT RIGHTS

- "The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title over all enriched uranium. The IAEA is a custodian, not an owner."
- "Material remains on Iranian soil by default. Iranian technicians supervise. Existing IAEA inspectors only. No foreign military personnel."
- "Iran selects the final disposition pathway freely from six options. US veto limited to Russia and hybrid only."
- "The JHTA is advisory and non-binding. PGSA remains sole coastal enforcement in Iranian territorial waters. IRGC authority preserved."

- "Day 45 default is not a breach. Pathway A continues automatically. Not a collapse. Not a trap."
- "Rolling Horizon: either party can withdraw with 90 days' notice. Funds already released cannot be clawed back."
- "Enrichment at 3.67% under full IAEA safeguards — our NPT right, fully preserved."

For Iranian Reformist Media

FOCUS: ECONOMIC OPENING, DIPLOMATIC ENGAGEMENT, REGIONAL STABILITY

- "SWIFT reconnection in four phases, restoring Iran's place in the global economy."
- "Frozen assets released through neutral escrow in Oman — Iranian money, not aid."
- "Petrochemical export licenses authorized. Agricultural trade expedited. Civilian aircraft parts permitted."
- "Performance-Based Graduation rewards compliance: 90 days clean certification expands sanctions relief."
- "Phase II negotiations must commence by Day 90. Parallel talks ensure momentum toward deeper normalization."
- "The Humanitarian Corridor through Hormuz: zero fees for medicine, food, medical equipment."

For International Media

FOCUS: GLOBAL STABILITY, MULTILATERALISM, ECONOMIC SECURITY

- "The Strait of Hormuz — through which one-third of global seaborne oil transits — governed under multilateral advisory coordination with UNCLOS compliance."
- "\$20 billion reinsurance backstop for Hormuz transit. Global energy security protected."
- "Six-state Distributed Guarantor Matrix: Oman, Pakistan, Qatar, China, Russia, EU/E3+. Trust distributed across multiple independent parties."
- "Zero-fee humanitarian corridor: medicine, food, fertilizer fast-tracked. Global agrifood crisis averted."
- "Modular architecture: failure in one module does not cascade. Maritime disputes cannot terminate humanitarian channels."

For Israeli Media

FOCUS: SECURITY, PARTICIPATION, SELF-DEFENSE

- "Full Israeli participation in the Levant Regional Basket. Dedicated Tel Aviv Channel for bilateral US-Israel coordination."
- "10-casualty threshold with JIG majority attribution for linking Lebanon to core deal — credible but not automatic."
- "Dossier Isolation Firewall: Hezbollah incidents cannot collapse the core US-Iran agreement."
- "Non-impediment clause: no third party can veto US implementation."
- "Article 51 self-defense right fully preserved. The Accord creates no constraints on Israeli security decisions."
- "Missile/drone deployment pause: no new transfers to proxies. Iran's regional threat frozen."

Section 9: The Sequencing Trap & How to Avoid It

The single most important strategic insight in this Package.

What Is the Sequencing Trap?

The sequencing trap is the structural dynamic that has killed every previous US-Iran agreement. It works like this:

1. **Side A announces the deal** and emphasizes the provisions that constitute Side A's victory.
2. **Side B is forced to "react."** Side B must now explain why the deal is actually good for Side B, despite Side A's framing.
3. **Side B looks defensive and reactive.** The public perceives Side B as having conceded, because Side B is now arguing against Side A's framing rather than stating its own positive case.
4. **Hardliners in Side B's capital mobilize.** "Our leader surrendered! Look at how they had to explain themselves after the Americans announced their victory!"
5. **The deal collapses.** Not because of the text, but because of the narrative sequence.

How v4.0 Solves the Sequencing Trap

The Simultaneous Announcement Protocol (Section 6) eliminates the sequencing trap through three mechanisms:

1. **Simultaneous Release:** Both statements go out at the same UTC timestamp. Neither side goes first. Neither side reacts. Both sides state their own truth simultaneously.

2. **Different Paragraphs:** Rubio points to paragraph 3 (physical custody). Baghaei points to paragraph 7 (legal title). Both are factually accurate. Both are legally operative. Neither contradicts the other.
3. **Pre-clearance:** Both statements are reviewed and approved by both capitals 24 hours before rollout. No surprises. No ad-libbing. No narrative drift.

THE GOLDEN RULE OF NARRATIVE SOVEREIGNTY

Never argue that the other side lost. Argue that your side won. The other side's victory is their problem to explain — not yours to deny.

When a US reporter asks, "Didn't Iran keep the uranium?" the answer is: "Physical custody is with the IAEA. Breakout time extended. That's a security win for America." Do not say, "Iran didn't keep it." They did keep legal title. That is their victory. Your victory is physical custody. State your victory. Let them state theirs.

When an Iranian reporter asks, "Didn't the US get monitoring access?" the answer is: "US technical observers at IAEA facilities. No operational control. No foreign military on Iranian soil. Iranian sovereignty preserved." Do not say, "The US didn't get access." They did get observer access. That is their victory. Your victory is no operational control and no foreign troops. State your victory. Let them state theirs.

The Narrative Architecture: A System, Not a Script

This Package is not a set of talking points to be memorized and recited. It is an *architecture* — a systematic approach to generating defensible, legally grounded narratives for any provision in the Accord.

The architecture has three components:

1. **The Optical Compromise:** Every provision produces two non-contradictory readings. Identify both.
2. **The Victory Frame:** Each side emphasizes the reading that constitutes their win. Do not deny the other side's reading.
3. **The Rebuttal:** Anticipate domestic criticism and ground the response in operative text, not rhetoric.

Final Guidance for Negotiators

When you are in the room, and the other side is pushing back on a provision, remember: they are not objecting to the text. They are objecting to how the text will play in their capital. Your job is not to win the argument. Your job is to make the provision defensible in *both* capitals.

Every time you find a provision that only one side can defend, stop. Redesign it. Add an optical layer. Create a dual frame. Find the paragraph that both sides can point to with pride.

That is how this Accord survives its first 72 hours. That is how it survives its first crisis. That is how it becomes durable peace rather than another failed framework.

*"An agreement that cannot be defended domestically
is an agreement that will be breached within a week."*

The Final Steps Accord Phase I v4.0 — Narrative Package v1.0
Late May 2026 — Authorized Negotiators Only